THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
FACULTY OF BUSINESS AND ECONOMICS

[Course Code] Economic Policy III

GENERAL INFORMATION

Instructor: Prof. Stephen Ching and Prof. Naijia Guo

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Consultation times: By appointment

Tutor: TBD

Pre-requisites: ECON6021 Microeconomic Analysis
Co-requisites: NA
Mutually exclusive: NA

Course Website: TBD
Reference Book: NA
The following programming languages are used in this course: English
No Software is used.

COURSE DESCRIPTION

This course in economic policy is taught by specialists in their respective areas of expertise. This self-contained course has two parts: 1) Labor market policies, including anti-discrimination laws, unemployment insurance, minimum wage laws, and migration policies, and 2) Housing, land, and rates (property taxes) in Hong Kong.

COURSE OBJECTIVES

This course will study and apply microeconomic and econometric theories to economic policy issues in the public sector. It will guide students to evaluate policies related to the labor market and housing market. Students will learn how to analyze economic data and address policy-related questions.

PROGRAMME LEARNING OUTCOMES

PLO1: Mastering of skills in analyzing economic data.

PLO2: Demonstration of ability to apply economic knowledge and analytical skills to address policy and business problems.

PLO3: Awareness of ethical concerns in economic issues.

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Course Learning Outcomes	Aligned Programme Learning Outcomes
CLO1: To study and apply microeconomic theories to economic policy issues in the public sector.	PLO1, PLO2, PLO3
CLO2: To study and apply econometric theories to economic policy issues in the public sector.	PLO1, PLO2, PLO3
CLO3: To develop one's economic reasoning and hone one's economic intuition.	PLO1, PLO2, PLO3

COURSE TEACHING AND LEARNING ACTIVITIES

Course Teaching and Learning Activities	Expected Hour	Study Load (% of study)
T&L1. Interactive lectures	30	25%
T&L2. Coursework	40	33%
T&L3. Self-study	50	42%
Total	[should range from 120 to 150]	100%

Assessment Methods	Brief Description (Optional)	Weight	Aligned Course Learning Outcomes
A1. Presentation (Labor Market)	Group presentation	50%	CLO1, 2, 3
A2. Final exam (Housing Market)	2-hour closed-book exam	50%	CLO1, 2, 3
	Total	100%	

STANDARDS FOR ASSESSMENT

Course Grade Descriptors

A+, A, A-	Strong evidence of excellent ability to fulfill the intended course learning outcomes.
B+, B, B-	Strong evidence of very good ability to fulfill the intended course learning outcomes.
C+, C, C-	Evidence of good ability to fulfill the intended course learning outcomes.
D+, D	Evidence of adequate ability to fulfill the intended course learning outcomes.
F	Evidence of poor ability to fulfill the intended course learning outcomes.

Assessment Rubrics for Coursework and Final Examination

A+, A, A-	Excellent ability to analyze economic policy issues with the microeconomic and econometric theories learnt.
B+, B, B-	Very good ability to analyze economic policy issues with the microeconomic and econometric theories learnt.
C+, C, C-	Good ability to analyze economic policy issues with the microeconomic and econometric theories learnt.
D+, D	Adequate ability to analyze economic policy issues with the microeconomic and econometric theories learnt.
F	Poor ability to analyze economic policy issues with the microeconomic and econometric theories learnt.

COURSE CONTENT AND TENTATIVE TEACHING SCHEDULE

Labor Market Policies

1. Anti-discrimination laws: Protections based on gender and race.
2. Unemployment insurance: Financial support for laid-off workers.
3. Minimum wage laws: Setting a floor for wages.
4. Immigration policies: Work visa and permits.
5. Internal migration policies: Hukou policies in China.

Housing, Land and Rates (Property Taxes) in Hong Kong

1. Long Term Housing Strategy
2. Land auctions and contestability
3. Rates (property taxes)

REQUIRED/RECOMMENDED READINGS & ONLINE MATERIALS (e.g. journals, textbooks, website addresses etc.)

To be announced on Moodle.

MEANS/PROCESSES FOR STUDENT FEEDBACK ON COURSE

- ○ Online response via Moodle site
- ○ Others: ___SFTL_____ (please specify)

COURSE POLICY (e.g. plagiarism, academic honesty, attendance, etc.)

An orderly learning environment is extremely important for this course. Disruptive behaviors are absolutely unacceptable. Academic dishonesty includes cheating, plagiarism, unauthorized collaboration, falsifying academic records, and any act designed to avoid participating honestly in the learning process. Any such dishonesty will result in an F grade.

ADDITIONAL COURSE INFORMATION (e.g. e-learning platforms & materials, penalty for late assignments, etc.)

Lecture notes and self-learning materials will be uploaded on Moodle.